

YOUR COURT HEARING SCRIPT

Prepared for: Maria Elena Rodriguez

This script helps you speak to the judge. You can bring this paper with you.

WHEN YOUR CASE IS CALLED: Walk to the front of the courtroom.

You: Good morning/afternoon, Your Honor. My name is Maria Elena Rodriguez.

Judge: Do you have an attorney?

You: No, Your Honor. I am representing myself.

Judge: Have you filed your Answer?

You: Yes, Your Honor. Here is a copy. (hand judge a copy of your Answer)

Judge: Do you owe the rent?

You: Your Honor, I dispute the amount claimed. I would like to explain why.

EXPLAIN YOUR DEFENSE: Now tell the judge:

YOUR DEFENSES (tell the judge):

1. The landlord failed to make necessary repairs despite being notified.
2. I dispute the amount of rent the landlord claims I owe.
3. I did not receive proper legal notice of the eviction.

IF YOU NEED MORE TIME:

You: Your Honor, I respectfully request additional time to resolve this matter.

CLOSING:

You: Thank you for hearing me, Your Honor.

TIPS: Dress neatly. Turn off your phone. Do not interrupt. Bring all documents. Speak clearly and respectfully. If you don't understand a question, ask the judge to repeat it.